

Support grows to vote out city attorney

A challenger of Hydee Feldstein Soto gains backing of D.A. and police union.

By JAMES QUEALLY

Los Angeles County Dist. Atty. Nathan Hochman and the union that represents rank-and-file police officers this week offered a stinging rebuke of embattled City Atty. Hydee Feldstein Soto while endorsing one of her challengers in the upcoming election, county prosecutor John McKinney.

Hochman said he analyzed the field and decided the city attorney's office "desperately needed" an experienced litigator like McKinney, who has been a prosecutor for 28 years and handled some of the city's highest-profile trials.

"What we need in the L.A. city attorney's office is someone who actually has courtroom experience, someone who understands how to win a trial," Hochman said. "Someone who has actually not only talked the talk, but walked the walk."

Hochman and leaders from the Los Angeles Police Protective League, the union that represents the majority of LAPD officers, stood shoulder to shoulder in endorsing McKinney. The league recently rescinded its endorsement of Feldstein Soto, who has faced criticism on a wide range of issues since she was elected in 2022.

Feldstein Soto's office was accused in recent weeks of failing to properly inform other city officials about a hack of confidential files that saw 337,000 documents, videos and photographs leaked online.

While many of the documents dealt with relatively



THE NEW Wilshire/Fairfax station is next to the Petersen Automotive Museum.

Three new stations to open on D Line extension

The stations will open Friday along Wilshire Boulevard, connecting Koreatown to neighborhoods to the west before eventually extending about five more miles next year.



65 years in the making: Rail backbone emerges

Metro to open segment of subway under Wilshire

By Jenny Jarvie

If a subway would work anywhere in modern Los Angeles, conventional wisdom said, it was along Wilshire Boulevard.

In 1962, California's then-governor, Edmund G. Brown, stood in downtown L.A. in the shadow of a rotary drilling rig to support local officials' plans for a new "Backbone Route" that would stretch west along L.A.'s most bustling

thoroughfare to the sea.

"Let's start drilling!" Brown declared, pulling a handle that started drilling the first hole of soil tests for a subway that planners estimated could be built in just three years.

No one back then thought it would take 65 years of political battles, funding struggles and worsening motor traffic for the Wilshire subway to actually

California under pressure to join redistricting war

Justices' voting rights ruling spurs calls for state to further redraw maps to counter GOP.

By Ana Ceballos

WASHINGTON — When the U.S. Supreme Court sharply curtailed a key provision of the Voting Rights Act last week, Democrats in Washington had a message: The rules of redistricting have changed, and California — the nation's biggest blue bastion — may have a further role to play.

Rep. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez (D-N.Y.) said Democrats should "play by the same set of rules" as Republicans. House Minority Leader Hakeem Jeffries (D-N.Y.) vowed to fight in "the Deep South and all over the country." And Rep. Terri Sewell, an Alabama Democrat, was blunt: "I'll take 52 seats from California, I sure would. And 17 seats from Illinois."

The calls for action came as Republican governors in Louisiana, Alabama, Mississippi and Tennessee called special legislative sessions to redraw congressional maps ahead of this year's midterm elections. Florida has also approved new maps that could give the GOP four more seats in the House, and President Trump urged other Republican states to follow suit.

The Republican response has intensified the

pressure on Democrats to act, including those in California — where the ruling could upend not just congressional maps, but also legislative and local races.

"We can't allow this national gerrymandering effort of Republicans to go unanswered," said Rep. Robert Garcia (D-Long Beach). "If Republicans go for it, I think we have to leave all options on the table."

For now, California's response is far from settled.

The chair of the California Democratic Party said there are no current plans to redraw maps — just months after voters approved a constitutional amendment authorizing a mid-decade redistricting backed by Gov. Gavin Newsom.

The Democratic consultant who drew the state's current congressional district boundaries says an all-blue map, while possible to create, would probably hurt Democrats more than help them in the long run. And some of the state's congressional Democrats are worried the impulse to match Republican partisan efforts would be bad for the American electorate.

"Rather than accelerating a race to the bottom, the next step is to dial it down because you can reach a point of no return," said Rep. Sydney Kamlager-Dove (D-Los Angeles), one of the state's most prominent Black lawmakers. "And that's where we're headed."

What California decides [See Redistricting, A7]



GUBERNATORIAL candidates spar Tuesday during a debate broadcast live from Monterey Park by CNN.

Becerra targeted in governor debate

Candidates clash on healthcare, wealth tax, immigration. There is some agreement too.

By Seema Mehta, Nicole Nixon and Kevin Rector

Democrat Xavier Becerra's rapid rise in California's race for governor made him a ripe and constant target during a combative nationally televised debate Tuesday evening, his first real test in a high-stakes election that remains highly volatile.

Becerra was ripped apart throughout the two-hour CNN debate, primarily by his Democratic rivals, who accused him of dodging questions about his stance on single-payer healthcare, falling short as a Biden Cabinet secretary and accepting a campaign donation from Chevron.

"I think everyone's invoking my name. It's nice to hear my name quite a bit," said Becerra, who served as the U.S. secretary of Health and Human Services during the Biden administration. "I will tell you this: Distorting the facts in your quest to be governor is never good, but using Trump lies to try to damage your opponents is worse, and that's what we see happening."

As ballots land in California voters' mailboxes, the state's seven top gubernatorial candidates clashed over

immigration, President Trump, tax policy, political temperament and a hodgepodge of scandals, mudslinging and other unsavory actions that have risen to the forefront of the hotly contested race.

The snarky, sometimes petulant exchanges reflect how unsettled the race to replace term-out Gov. Gavin Newsom is, as well as California's outsized economic and political gravitas on the national and international stage.

Shortly after the debate began, former Orange County Rep. Katie Porter chastised her fellow candidates for their unceasing attacks.

"I can't believe [the] interrupting and bickering and name-calling and shouting and disrespect for everyone up here who's stepping into public service that anyone wants to talk about my temperament," said the former Democratic Congress member from Irvine.

Becerra takes his lumps onstage

Beccerra, who has surged in the weeks before the June 2 primary, faced a barrage of attacks from his Republican and Democratic rivals about his oversight of unaccompanied immigrant minors during his tenure at the Health and Human Services Department and his relationship with a longtime advisor who, along with other con-

Immigration raids sour O.C. on Trump

By Hannah Fry

In a troubling sign for Republicans in the upcoming midterms, Orange County voters are souring on President Trump and particularly his crackdown on illegal immigration.

A new poll released by UC Irvine's School of Social Ecology shows support for

Trump among Orange County voters is down to 35%, with 65% of participants saying they do not approve of the president's performance. His hard-line immigration policies have proved to be particularly unpopular, with 6 in 10 residents disapproving of his actions, according to the survey, a stark contrast to the county's historical stance on

the issue.

And, experts say, the poll results in this county — largely seen as a bellwether in recent years — might not bode well for Republicans who are already facing an uphill battle heading into the November midterms where voters, in general, tend to favor the party that's not in power.

Although Democrats

have carried the county in recent presidential elections, Orange County remains a decidedly purple area and home to some of the most contested congressional districts in recent years.

Those contests were expected to be less competitive this year after California voters approved Democratic

TED TURNER, 1938 – 2026

Creator of 24-hour news cycle changed television



CNN FOUNDER Ted Turner started the Cable News Network in 1980, revolutionizing the media industry.

By Matt Pearce and Meg James

Ted Turner, the brash media mogul who created CNN and revolutionized how Americans watched television, and who wielded his media empire and wealth to pursue liberal global causes and land conservation, has died. He was 87.

Turner died Wednesday at his home in Lamont, Fla., according to his family. They did not disclose his cause of death.

In 2018, he revealed he had been diagnosed with Lewy body dementia, a neurodegenerative disease, which had been progressing

U.S. fires on Iranian tanker
Attack occurs amid a ceasefire and as countries appear to be moving closer to a deal to end the war. **WORLD, A3**

UCLA accused of racial bias
Justice Department says Geffen School of Medicine violated Civil Rights Act in admissions. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

L.A. mayoral candidates spar
For coverage of Wednesday evening's three-way Los Angeles mayoral debate, visit latimes.com/politics.

Weather
Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 77/58. **B6**

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